

The Switchover

Site	Delivery Method	Pros	Cons
Brown Bag Training	Online	Clean Interface, Live Instructor	None
YouAchieve.com	Online	Huge number of courses available; articles and 'nuggets' in addition to courses; affordable	None
Silicon Beach Training	HTML Pages	Free; large number of links	No formal training option for non-UK customers; you only get to use the free links
Get Ahead Direct	CD-ROMs; eBooks	Very affordable eBook option	Limited number of titles
NAM Virtual University	Online	Reasonably Affordable	Somewhat limited selection of soft skills courses
CRM Learning	VHS or DVD	High-quality products	Expensive

for your team or tailor their existing classes to address a specific market, skill or customer base.

A typical class is completed in about 45 minutes and all students receive an electronic certificate of completion. Visit http://snipurl.com/digit_skills2 for more details about the classes offered. Some examples are "Customer Service 101", "Eight tips for writing quality e-mail", "Dealing with difficult customers" and so on.

You Achieve

www.youachieve.com

At YouAchieve.com, you will find a variety of learning resources—workshops, clinics, articles, 'knowledge nuggets', intensive programs and 'PowerBytes' (small tidbits of key information you can access for free). All content is delivered via the Internet.

Three types of full-access subscriptions ranging from a month, three months to one year are available. Each gives you access to the entire course catalogue for the chosen duration. A one-month subscription is only \$46 (Rs 2,070).

The 'Intensive Programmes' include material on leadership skills, personal career development and personal management skills amongst others. The workshops offered include interaction skills, oral communication, corporate leadership, personal development and other essential skills. The clinics are short (20-minute) 'courses'.

Silicon Beach Training

http://snipurl.com/digit_skills3

This site has a compilation of many free e-learning resources that are available. Here, you will find links to books that you can purchase, links to forums, articles, tips and tricks and much more. The topics are arranged alphabetically from 'assertiveness skills' to 'communication skills' to 'time management'.

Get Ahead Direct

www.getahead-direct.com

GetAhead offers CD-ROMs and eBooks as training material. While an eBook is for \$8.95 (Rs 403), a multimedia CD-ROM costs \$39.95 (Rs 1,798). There are ten titles available in all for \$199 (Rs 8,955) for all the CD-ROMs.

Each GetAhead training course (eBook or CD-Rom) is a comprehensive and self-contained course that will give you a 'lifelong career skill'. Each course is designed by experts to include interactive exercises, case studies and questions.

The 10 titles available are Busi-

mation Technology. The soft skills part of the catalogue includes courses relating to customer service, personal development and professional development.

For instance under 'Personal Development', there are courses in 'Managing Stress', 'Recognising and Managing Anger', 'Recognising and Avoiding Burnout', 'Time Management' and more. Each course is priced at \$9.95 (Rs 448).

Courses typically take an hour to complete. All courses are delivered over the Internet. To use this, you need to register and enrol for a course and it will be delivered to you when you want it.

The flipside to such an arrangement is that the lessons are pre-recorded and there is no live instructor.

CRM Learning

www.crmlearning.com

CRM Learning allows you to take an online preview of some of its courses before deciding if they will be right for you. The method of delivery is either VHS or DVD.

As with the other sites mentioned so far, the soft skills offered there are communication skills, customer service, ethics, leadership, and so on.

CRM Learning offers a 'Purchase' option and it's a good thing it let's you preview! Typically, the purchase of the titles costs \$795 (Rs 37,500) whereas 'rental' costs \$275 (Rs 13,000).

This means that you can order the tapes or disks and present them to your entire team at your convenience. However, the 'rental' option may not be available to Indian customers due to shipping issues.

Titles in the soft-skills department include 'The power of listening', 'Communicating non-defensively', 'Attitude is Everything', 'Really Angry Customers' and others. ☒

ram_mohan@thinkdigit.com



CRM Learning is expensive, but offers high-quality training

ness Negotiations, Time Management, Business Presentations, Winning at Interviews, Business Meetings, Organising Projects, Planning Projects, Controlling Projects, Business Analysis and Data Analysis. Some of these may be classified as soft skills, some not quite.

GetAhead also has an impressive customer list, which includes the likes of Sun Microsystems, Sony, IBM, AT&T, Kodak and Compaq among others.

NAM Virtual University

www.namvu.com

The catalogue at NAM Virtual University includes soft skills training as well as training in other departments such as Infor-